Golden Visa 2026: investment residency programmes compared

Last checked: 2026-10-14 · Not legal advice. Rules change — verify with the official source.

Important (2026): Lei Orgânica 1/2026, in force since 19 May 2026 — citizenship now requires 10 years of legal residence (7 years for EU and CPLP nationals), counted from the first permit's issue date. Nationality applications filed by 18 May 2026 keep the old 5-year rule. The main ARI route is €500,000+ in qualifying Portuguese funds (no real estate, ≥5-year maturity, ≥60% in Portuguese companies).

COUNTRY	MIN INVESTMENT	ROUTES	TIME TO CITIZENSHIP	RU/BY PASSPORTS	OFFICIAL SOURCE	LAST CHECKED
Portugal ARI (Golden Visa)	€500,000	Qualifying Portuguese non-real-estate funds (≥5-year maturity, ≥60% in Portuguese companies); company creation €500K + 5 jobs; research €500K; culture €250K; 10 jobs. Real estate and the €1.5M capital transfer were removed in 10/2023	10 yrs non-EU/CPLP; 7 yrs EU/CPLP (Lei Orgânica 1/2026, in force 19.05.2026; counted from permit issue)	Not excluded by law; enhanced AML / source-of-funds checks. Bank and fund practice varies BEING VERIFIED	vistos.mne.gov.pt — ARI AIMA — art. 90.º-A Lei Orgânica n.º 1/2026 (DR n.º 95/2026, Série I, 18.05.2026)	2026-10-14
Italy Investor Visa	€250,000	€250K innovative startup; €500K Italian company / VC fund; €2M government bonds; €1M philanthropy; held 2 yrs	~10 yrs of residence (general rule) BEING VERIFIED	**Suspended for RU/BY citizens, including RU/BY dual nationals**	investorvisa.mise.gov.it D.Lgs. 286/1998 art. 26-bis	2026-10-14
Greece Golden Visa	€250,000 (exceptions only)	€800K Attica / Thessaloniki / Mykonos / Santorini / islands >3,100 inhabitants; €400K elsewhere (single property ≥120 m²); €250K only for conversion to residential or listed-building restoration BEING VERIFIED	7 yrs of residence (general rule) BEING VERIFIED	**New applications by RU/BY nationals (incl. family members) suspended since 01.04.2022; confirmed by Ministry of Migration Circular 1 of 21.04.2026**	migration.gov.gr — Golden Visa Циркуляр 1 / Circular 1, 21.04.2026 (Diavgeia ΨΣΙ746ΜΔΨΟ-ΔΧΜ)	2026-10-14
Spain Golden Visa — closed	— closed	Golden visa abolished 03.04.2025 (LO 1/2025, DF 21). Alternatives: non-lucrative residence, digital nomad visa, entrepreneur	n/a	n/a	BOE-A-2025-76 (LO 1/2025)	2026-10-14
Thailand LTR Wealthy Global Citizen	US$500,000 invested in Thailand + US$1M global assets	Thai government bonds / company, VC, PE / property; US$50K insurance or US$100K deposit; 10-yr visa (5+5)	Not a citizenship route	Not excluded BEING VERIFIED	ltr.boi.go.th	2026-10-14
UAE Golden Visa (property)	AED 2,000,000	Property (registered ownership from AED 2M; approved-bank mortgage allowed); other categories exist	Not a citizenship route	BEING VERIFIED	icp.gov.ae — UAE Golden Residency	BEING VERIFIED
Hungary Guest Investor	€250,000	MNB real-estate fund units from €250K (≥5 yrs) or a €1M donation to a university. The €500K property option was withdrawn before launch (Gazette 20.12.2024)	BEING VERIFIED	BEING VERIFIED	oif.gov.hu — Guest Investor	BEING VERIFIED

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Malta MPRP (permanent residence)	Assets €500K (incl. €150K liquid) + housing + contributions	Property purchase from €375K or lease from €14K/yr + €60K admin + €37K contribution + €2K donation (L.N. 146/2025) BEING VERIFIED	PR ≠ passport: naturalisation needs real residence BEING VERIFIED	**Applications from Russia and Belarus currently not eligible (Residency Malta FAQ, v2.6.5)**	residencymalta.gov.mt — MPRP Residency Malta — MPRP FAQ v2.6.5	BEING VERIFIED

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